



UN MILLENNIUM DEVELOPMENT

GOALS REPORT, 2008 India, where girls still wait for primary school access in some regions, trails Sri Lanka and Maldives in meeting targets set in the Millennium Development Goals.



GLOBAL CORRUPTION

PERCEPTION INDEX, 2008 India's rank has fallen from 72 in 2004 to 85 even as China, with which it was on par till last year, maintained its position at 72.



UNIDO REPORT, 2009

India, at 54 (down from 51 in 2000), trails China by 28 positions on the Competitive Industrial Performance Index.



INDEX OF ECONOMIC

FREEDOM, 2009 With a shackled judicial system, excessive regulation and a "mostly unfree" reputation, India, at 123, trails Gabon.



TRAVEL & TOURISM COMPETITIVENESS

REPORT, 2009 India ranks low at 62 with inadequate tourism infrastructure. Smaller countries like Puerto Rico and Panama are way above India.



scores below Equatorial Guinea and Solomon Islands in the Global Development Report. The female-to-male ratio for literacy rate is just 0.65 and as per the World Bank, 41.6 per cent of Indians are currently living below poverty line. India's maternal mortality rate stands at 450 per 1,00,000 live births, against 540 in 1998-1999. The figures are way behind the MDGs which call for a reduction of that figure to below 109 by 2015. The World Bank warns that the rate of absenteeism among primary healthcare workers in India is the highest at 40 per cent, and this hampers meeting the MDGs.

Votaries of India's high economic prospects would call the ranking grossly unfair since the 2008 HDI ranking is based on data from 2006—which is normal considering usual lags—but does not take into account the massive investments that have been made since 2006 in areas such as infrastructure development.

3-4%

is the proportion of India's GDP spent on education, which is far less than countries like Namibia and Bolivia.

Any opinion about India, says Seeta Prabhu, senior assistant country director, UNDP, must take into account that HDI indicators take a long time to reflect change. "Health is influenced by levels of income, safe water supply, adequate and clean housing, access to public health services, and so on. Flagship programmes like NREGS will take time to make an impact but it has in 2008-09 alone generated employment of 1,388 million person days covering 35 million households," says